

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader moving closer to the model — AI shipped into production, not demoed

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

EMAIL

hello@treppmann.design

PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/fin

LINKEDIN

linkedin.com/in/tobiastreppmann

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years and led design teams for more than a decade of that, and I spent the last year moving closer to the model. At Bibel TV that means a support copilot live in production, an AI fundraising system I built solo end to end, and prototypes running on real APIs that engineering ships from. Before that, the prompt-to-database onboarding model I designed for Ninox's founders, design leadership at ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — a Microsoft Copilot skill I designed and scoped, not a custom build. It drafts viewer letters, emails and social messages in the support handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and the draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry. It is operated manually and embedded in nothing, so a person has already read the letter before the model sees it and every send decision stays human.
- Quality agreed before the prompt was tuned — the support team spelled out what counts as a good draft first. Rollout was fully optional: a week of self-testing, then one-to-one sessions, then team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Validation was qualitative observation, not a scored golden set. Complex letters now take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and sceptics converted after their hardest case.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysed past letters against their performance for the seasonality and style patterns that separate the strong from the weak, encoded that into a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before it generates, built the prototype, then shipped a Claude skill producing follow-up content across in-app notifications, web banners and video scripts.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and engineering ships from that code. Around 70% of AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours, and web-first assumptions got corrected on the Android prototype before production work started.
- Design system as an API — DTGK tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Android and Figma are live, iOS and web endpoints defined. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- App redesign — leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries. The hard constraints here were legal, not technical.
- Customer-service workflow, designed and initiated — shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified for parish teams handling enquiries and requests. Only the booking module went live before the M&A centralisation.
- Booking module, product and design both — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, coordinating 20+ cemeteries at the launch customer. 1 direct report.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, after my employment there) — the AI generates a working schema from a description, and it renders into the real data-model editor rather than a chat preview. Chat and direct manipulation sit side by side, because the first schema is almost always wrong and typing corrections into a chat log does not scale. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — design established as a function co-equal with product and engineering. Hired two, let two go.
- Coaching a peer in craft — coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship, and set up shared design-system governance across 4 designers and engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the shared service centre. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue, and I worked with IT on the service-desk and ITSM implementation.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the programme.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Research inside regulated industries — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach people working inside banks and insurers. The design system was co-built: UX defined component behaviour and specs, UI executed the visual system.
- Design as a business partner — secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

AI Chops — Model Behaviour and Agent Workflows

Agent workflows in production: handbook loaded as context, an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt, manual operation so a person reads every message first, the send decision always human · Prompt architecture with clarifying-question loops before generation · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Quality targets agreed with the people who use the output, before prompt tuning · Structured rollout and qualitative validation

Agentic Engineering and AI-Product Craft

Claude Code, Claude Projects, Claude skills · Microsoft Copilot · Prototypes running on real APIs that engineering ships from · Around 70% of AI-generated code lands; iteration days to hours · Web-first assumptions caught on the Android prototype before production · AI alt-text shipped under GDPR-plus data-protection law

Design Leadership and Coaching Senior ICs

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Hiring and performance calls in both directions · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, OKLCH · Live sync to Android and Figma, iOS and web endpoints defined · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

Research, Experimentation and Distributed Teams

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas inside regulated institutions · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2